

▼ **NOTRE-DAME CATHEDRAL**

Dating from the middle part of the 12th century, the cathedral of Notre-Dame de Paris (see pp.134-135), shown here before the fire of April 2019, is an important example of French Gothic. It makes use of a number of important structural innovations, including rib vaulting, flying buttresses, and multiple elaborate rose windows.

lofty details, even though not visible from ground level, are intended to be visible to God

the spire was the highest point of the structure

12 medallions in the inner circle depict the 12 apostles

20 angels are depicted in the outer circle

trefoil shape symbolizes Holy Trinity

◁ **ROSE WINDOW**

Though present in Romanesque architecture, the rose window became a characteristic Gothic form. The circular window, or oculus, is split up into often elaborate segments, which are then filled by stained glass, usually depicting biblical figures or stories.

second and third circles depict martyrs and saints

oldest glass is from 12th century

flying buttresses span 50 ft (15 m)

support of flying buttresses allows higher and thinner walls

counter-supports are topped with stone pinnacles to add greater weight

projecting pier helps to shed rainwater

South Rose Window depicts Christ surrounded by saints and apostles

simple Gothic arch

transept runs north to south

main vault inside the cathedral is 112 ft (34 m) high

flying buttresses are a 13th-century addition

south aisle of nave

rib vault allows for decoration in cells and on bosses (knobs at intersections of rib vaults)

vertical column transfers load from rib to ground

each vault is divided into six compartments

rib, or projecting band

vault is divided by ribs into compartments called cells

◁ **VAULTED CEILINGS**

The rib vault is a key structural innovation. In earlier buildings, the load was carried by intersecting vaults called groin vaults. However, with the rib vault, the load is carried only by the protruding structural members—the ribs—and it is much more flexible.

